

Sealed Keystone Crate

Player-facing description

A sealed crate sits in the back of the carriage, heavier than it looks, banded shut, and unmarked. You're told three things: it is important, you are not to open it, and it goes to the village.

Public role

The sealed package the party is hired to escort

Handout text

The package is sealed and important. Deliver it. Do not open it.

GM truth

This is the container around the Keystone Asset, but the Prologue must never put that name in player-facing text.

GM handling

Make the mystery physical without solving it. The crate is a job constraint first and a reveal later.

Mechanics

- Title: Discovery / Earn-It Mechanics
- Player Safe: Players can inspect, handle, keep, trade, reveal, or earn Sealed Keystone Crate when it is present in the fiction.
- Gm Only: Use the roll only when the player's method, stakes, and consequence are concrete.
- No Roll Reveals: Surface read: A heavy sealed crate in the back of the carriage. In the Prologue it is only the package. Give obvious visible facts freely; roll for meaning, risk, leverage, cost, or a hidden angle.
- Rolls: entity-sealed-keystone-crate-engage-sealed-keystone-crate entity-sealed-keystone-crate Engage Sealed Keystone Crate Engage Sealed Keystone Crate Knowledge Finesse Instinct Presence Knowledge Finesse, Instinct, Presence 12 Choose the trait from the player's method, not the entity type. A flat read of Sealed Keystone Crate hides the cost, motive, or useful next step. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the...
- Fear Spends: Reveal who benefits from the current situation. Make the cost personal

without closing off player agency.

- Condition Options: No official condition unless the item or clue physically creates Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable
- Search Loot: Tampering logs the attempt and may create later corporate attention; careful inspection shows the cargo is ward-related.

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